

Beneath the surface, oceans are packed with fascinating features, wonderful wildlife, and ancient treasures. From the largest and the longest to the deepest and the oldest, the oceans' record-breaking secrets are revealed here.

Largest living structure

Key features

The Great Barrier Reef, off the coast of Australia, is the largest living structure on Earth.

It is about 132,900 sq miles (344,400 sq km) in area.

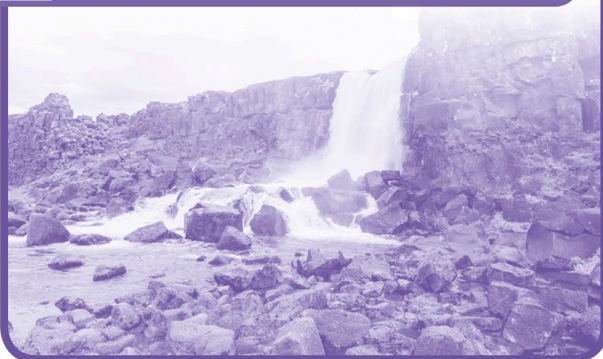


Longest mountain chain

Key features

The mid-ocean ridge mountain chain stretches for 40,389 miles (65,000 km).

It is almost completely underwater and has thousands of volcanoes.



Loudest animal

Key features

The sperm whale makes a clicking sound that reaches 230 decibels—almost twice as loud as the loudest human scream!

Sperm whales can hear each other from 10 miles (16km) away.



Most ancient fish

Key features

The oldest type of fish on Earth is the coelacanth.

This giant animal has existed for more than 360 million years.

